FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

AI for Planning & Differentiation

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session in which every teacher differentiates a real upcoming lesson: core version, support version, extension, quality-reviewed and taught that week. Run by your own coach or teacher-leader; no consultant required.

Why this matters now

Differentiation has research behind it: a meta-analysis (Deunk et al., 2018) found positive effects, strongest when it's embedded in instruction and supported by technology. What it never had was a sustainable cost: three versions of everything by hand. That cost just collapsed. 61% of teachers now use AI in their work (EdWeek Research Center, 2026), with lesson plans and student resources among the most common uses, and 60–84% of teachers using AI for a given task say it saves them time (Gallup & Walton Family Foundation, 2025). This session converts that time savings into differentiated materials, with a verification habit attached: a peer-reviewed study (PLOS ONE, 2024) showed ChatGPT drafting a standards-aligned lesson in about 30 minutes while also inserting flaws and one fabricated resource, so teacher review is built into every step.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Run the planning workflow: draft, options, pick, review; never from a blank page again
- Use four differentiation moves with copy-ready prompts: level it, scaffold it, stretch it, reformat it
- Verify AI-leveled texts instead of trusting the label
- Apply a 4-point review (accurate · at level · fits · sounds like you) before anything reaches a student
- Own one fully differentiated artifact for a lesson taught this week
- Sustain a one-artifact-per-week habit through three 10-minute PLC follow-ups

The equity angle

RAND (2025) found 25% of teachers used AI for planning or teaching in 2023–24, with higher-poverty schools lagging. Differentiation help is exactly where that gap bites hardest. Whole-staff training plus a shared prompt library is how a school makes these tools narrow gaps instead of widening them.

Research base in brief

Differentiation effects: Deunk et al. (2018); Tomlinson et al. (2003) · UDL frame: CAST UDL Guidelines 3.0 (2024); Capp (2017) · AI lesson-drafting evidence and limits: Powell & Courchesne, PLOS ONE (2024) · Readability verification: Crossley et al. (2022, CLEAR corpus) · Adoption & time data: EdWeek Research Center (2026); Gallup–Walton Family Foundation (2025); RAND RR-A134-25 (2025). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

Where it fits

Kit 3 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**, after Kit 1 (safety rules) and Kit 2 (prompting). Ships with a 30-day plan (three 10-minute PLC follow-ups, no new meetings) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD